

PothwariSentiment **Annotation Guidelines**

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Project: PothwariSentiment - First Ever Sentiment Analysis
Dataset for the Pothwari Language

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1. Project Overview

1.1 Background

This document provides the official annotation guidelines for PothwariSentiment, the first publicly available sentiment analysis dataset for the Pothwari language. Pothwari (also written as Potohari, Potwari, or Pothohari) is an Indo-Aryan language spoken primarily in the Rawalpindi-Islamabad region of Punjab, Pakistan, and is classified under the Pahari-Pothwari dialect continuum. Despite being spoken by 35 to 40 million people, Pothwari has no existing labelled NLP resources in any public repository or published academic literature. This dataset addresses that gap.

1.2 Purpose

I present the first structured written corpus of Pothwari in Nastaliq script, with sentiment annotation as the foundational NLP layer — providing the first machine-readable written resource for a language spoken by millions with zero prior digital representation. The goal of this annotation task is to assign a sentiment label to each Pothwari sentence in the dataset. Sentiment labels reflect the emotional tone expressed by the writer or speaker of the sentence. There are three possible labels: Positive, Negative, and Neutral.

Your labels must reflect the sentiment expressed in the sentence itself — not your personal opinion about the topic being discussed, and not how the sentence makes you feel as a reader.

Read this entire document before labelling any sentence. During annotation, if you are unsure about any sentence, return to this document before making a decision. Do not guess.

1.3 Data Sources and Copyright Policy

All sentences included in the PothwariSentiment dataset must originate from one of the following approved sources only:

Approved Source 1 — Direct Annotator Contributions

Sentences written originally by project annotators specifically for this dataset. These are fully owned by the contributor who, by participating in this project, grants irrevocable permission for their contributions to be published under CC BY 4.0.

Approved Source 2 — Invited Pothwari Author Contributions (Target: 500 sentences / 25%)

Original sentences written specifically for this dataset by established Pothwari writers and literary figures contacted directly by the project lead. These contributors are invited based on their recognized command of the Pothwari language and their active involvement in Pothwari literary or cultural activity.

These contributors write original sentences — not existing published works — following the same structured prompts provided to annotators in Source 1. Their contributions add linguistic richness and register diversity to the dataset, representing the language as used by writers with deep literary familiarity with Pothwari.

Before contributing, each invited author confirms the same written consent statement as Source 1 contributors (see Section 1.4), granting permission for their originally written sentences to be published under CC BY 4.0 with attribution to them by name in the dataset documentation.

Their name and designation (e.g., "Pothwari poet, Rawalpindi") is recorded in the dataset's contributor acknowledgements section. This attribution is both an ethical requirement and a feature — it demonstrates the dataset's connection to the active Pothwari literary community.

Sentiment balance prompts identical to Source 1 are provided to these contributors. The project lead monitors running category counts and adjusts prompts accordingly.

Not Approved — Copyrighted Published Works

Text from published books, book foundation collections, or any authored literary work where permission has not been explicitly obtained must not be included in this dataset. This includes collections from Tooba Book Foundation, Mirpur Folks blog poetry, and any named poet's published sher(couplet) without explicit written consent

1.4 Contributor Consent Statement

Before any contributor writes a single sentence for this dataset, they must confirm the following statement in writing via WhatsApp message to the project lead:

"I confirm that I am a native speaker of Pothwari as spoken in the Rawalpindi region. I agree to contribute original sentences to the PothwariSentiment dataset. I understand that my contributions will be published publicly as part of an open academic dataset under CC BY 4.0 license, meaning anyone can freely use, share, and build upon them with attribution. My participation is entirely voluntary."

The project lead saves a screenshot of every contributor's consent message in the private records folder before that contributor begins writing sentences. No contributed sentences are used without prior confirmed consent.

2. Script, Language Variety, and Orthographic Standards

2.1 Script Decision

All sentences in the UdtPothwar dataset are written exclusively in Nastaliq script using the Perso-Arabic writing system standard in Pakistan. This decision reflects the historically established written tradition of Pothwari, which — where written forms exist — has always used the Shahmukhi/Nastaliq script as documented in classical works including those of Mian Muhammad Bakhsh (1830–1907).

No Roman transliteration is accepted in this dataset under any circumstances. This restriction exists for two reasons. First, no standardized Roman orthography exists for Pothwari — informal online romanization varies entirely by individual preference and cannot be enforced consistently across contributors. Second, the purpose of this dataset is to establish the first structured written corpus of Pothwari in its authentic script. Accepting Roman text would undermine this foundational contribution.

2.2 Language Variety

This dataset specifically represents the Rawalpindi-region variety of Pothwari as spoken in Rawalpindi district and the Islamabad Capital Territory. This variety is linguistically distinct from:

- Pahari as spoken in Azad Jammu and Kashmir (covered by Gardazi et al., 2026)
- Mirpuri Pothwari as spoken in Mirpur district
- Pahari as spoken in the Murree-Galyat area

Contributors must be native speakers of the Rawalpindi-region variety specifically. Sentences reflecting other regional varieties should be flagged for review rather than labelled or included directly.

2.3 Orthographic Standards — Critical

This section is the most important technical instruction in the entire document. Read it carefully before writing a single sentence.

Pothwari has no formally published orthographic standard. This dataset is the first attempt to write Pothwari systematically and consistently in Nastaliq at scale. Every sentence contributed to this dataset is therefore an orthographic decision — a small act of establishing how this language looks in written form.

Contributors must follow these orthographic rules without exception:

Rule 1 — Use Pothwari grammatical markers, not Urdu equivalents

Pothwari and Urdu share the same script but have different grammatical markers. Always use the Pothwari form:

Function	Pothwari (Use This)	Urdu (Do Not Use)
Masculine possessive	نا	کا
Feminine possessive	نی	کی
Plural possessive	نے	کے
First person singular present	آن	ہوں
Second/third person plural present	او/پے	ہیں
Past tense marker	سا	تھا / تھی / تھے
Negation	نئیں	نہیں
This/that	ایہہ / اوہ	یہ / وہ
Come/go (present)	اشنا / گشنا	آتا / جاتا

Rule 2 — Use Pothwari vocabulary where it differs from Urdu

When a Pothwari word exists that differs from its Urdu equivalent, use the Pothwari word. Do not substitute Urdu vocabulary because it is easier to type or more familiar in written form.

Common examples:

Meaning	Pothwari (Use This)	Urdu (Do Not Use)
Good / Fine	چنگا	اچھا
Very	بوں / بڑا	بہت
To say / speak	آکھنا	کہنا
To do	کرنا (shared)	کرنا
House	کار	گھر
Water	پانی (shared)	پانی
To eat	کھانا (shared)	کھانا
Now	ہن	اب
Why	کیاں	کیوں
What	کےہ	کیا

Note: Many words are shared between Pothwari and Urdu. Shared vocabulary is acceptable. The rule applies specifically where a distinct Pothwari form exists — in those cases the Pothwari form must be used.

Rule 3 — The authenticity test

Before submitting any sentence, apply this test: would you say this sentence exactly this way to a family member at home in Pothwari? If the sentence sounds like formal Urdu with one or two Pothwari words, revise it. If it sounds like natural spoken Pothwari written down, submit it.

Rule 4 — Diacritics (Zabar, Zer, Pesh)

Add diacritics where they are necessary to distinguish meaning or ensure correct pronunciation. Do not add diacritics to every word — that is unnecessary and inconsistent with how Nastaliq is normally written. Add them only where their absence would cause genuine ambiguity.

Rule 5 — Typing method

Contributors who find Nastaliq typing difficult are encouraged to use the voice-to-text function on their smartphone's Urdu keyboard. Speak the sentence in Pothwari naturally. The phone will produce approximate Nastaliq output in Urdu. The contributor then corrects the grammatical markers and vocabulary to their authentic Pothwari equivalents using Rules 1 and 2 above. This correction step typically involves 2-4 word changes per sentence and takes under 30 seconds.

2.4 Quality Control for Authenticity

The project lead reviews every contributed sentence specifically for linguistic authenticity before it enters the dataset. Any sentence that:

- Uses Urdu grammatical markers where Pothwari markers exist
- Uses exclusively formal Urdu vocabulary with no Pothwari features
- Appears to be an Urdu sentence with superficial Pothwari substitutions

will be returned to the contributor for revision with specific feedback on which words or markers need changing. Sentences that cannot be revised into authentic Pothwari will be discarded.

This quality control step is not a criticism of contributors — it is the mechanism that ensures this dataset represents genuine Pothwari rather than Urdu in a Pothwari register. The linguistic integrity of the entire corpus depends on this distinction being maintained consistently.

3. Label & Sentence Definitions

3.1 Definition of a Valid Sentence

For the purposes of this dataset, a valid sentence is defined as follows:

Length: Between 5 and 50 words. Anything shorter than 5 words lacks sufficient context for reliable sentiment judgement. Anything longer than 50 words likely contains multiple sentiments and should be split or discarded.

Unity: One sentence expresses one coherent thought or emotion. If a statement contains two clearly separate ideas — even joined by "اور" or "پر" — it must be split into two separate meaningful sentences before submission. Each part must independently meet the 5 word minimum.

Completion: A sentence must be grammatically complete and independently understandable without additional context. Incomplete thoughts, sentence fragments, or statements that only make sense when read alongside another sentence are not valid.

Script: Written entirely in Nastaliq script. No Roman characters, no English words, no numerals unless the numeral is integral to the meaning and cannot be written otherwise.

Examples of valid sentences:

- A complete opinion about food, a person, an event, or a situation
- A complete factual statement about something observable
- A complete question with clear emotional tone or no emotional tone
- A complete blessing, prayer, or expression of feeling

Examples of invalid sentences — discard these:

- Sentences under 5 words even if emotionally clear
- Sentences over 50 words — split them first, then evaluate each part
- Sentences mixing Roman and Nastaliq script
- Sentences that are clearly incomplete thoughts
- Sentences requiring the previous sentence for context

Handling Pothwari Couplets (Sher):

A sher consists of two lines (مصرع). Each line is treated as a separate sentence and evaluated independently. Do not submit or label a full couplet as one unit. Split it into its two individual lines first, verify each line meets the 5-word minimum, then submit them as two separate entries. The separate entities must be meaningful on their own.

Label Definitions and Examples

3.2 POSITIVE

A sentence is labelled POSITIVE when it expresses any of the following: happiness, joy, praise, satisfaction, love, gratitude, excitement, pride, approval, hope, or any other favourable emotion or opinion toward a person, object, event, or situation.

Example sentences labelled POSITIVE:

1. [Pothwari sentence expressing happiness about the day] — *Reason: expresses joy*
2. [Pothwari sentence praising someone's work] — *Reason: expresses approval and praise*
3. [Pothwari sentence expressing love for family] — *Reason: expresses affection*
4. [Pothwari sentence saying food is delicious] — *Reason: expresses satisfaction*
5. [Pothwari sentence expressing gratitude to God] — *Reason: expresses gratitude*
6. [Pothwari sentence expressing excitement about an event] — *Reason: expresses excitement*
7. [Pothwari sentence congratulating someone] — *Reason: expresses approval and warmth*
8. [Pothwari sentence expressing pride in a child's achievement] — *Reason: expresses pride*

3.3 NEGATIVE

A sentence is labelled NEGATIVE when it expresses any of the following: sadness, anger, frustration, disappointment, criticism, complaint, hatred, jealousy, regret, fear, or any other unfavourable emotion or opinion toward a person, object, event, or situation.

Example sentences labelled NEGATIVE:

1. [Pothwari sentence complaining about bad work] — *Reason: expresses criticism*
2. [Pothwari sentence expressing sadness] — *Reason: expresses sadness*
3. [Pothwari sentence expressing anger at someone] — *Reason: expresses anger*
4. [Pothwari sentence expressing disappointment about an outcome] — *Reason: expresses disappointment*
5. [Pothwari sentence saying a place is terrible] — *Reason: expresses disapproval*
6. [Pothwari sentence expressing frustration] — *Reason: expresses frustration*
7. [Pothwari sentence expressing regret about a decision] — *Reason: expresses regret*
8. [Pothwari sentence expressing worry or fear] — *Reason: expresses fear*

3.4 NEUTRAL

A sentence is labelled NEUTRAL when it conveys factual information, states an observation, asks a plain question, or makes a statement with no emotional leaning in either direction. The sentence neither praises nor criticizes. It simply states something.

Example sentences labelled NEUTRAL:

1. [Pothwari sentence stating a meeting will happen tomorrow] — *Reason: factual statement, no emotion*
2. [Pothwari sentence saying someone went to the market] — *Reason: factual observation*
3. [Pothwari sentence asking what time school starts] — *Reason: plain question, no emotion*
4. [Pothwari sentence saying it rained yesterday] — *Reason: factual weather observation*
5. [Pothwari sentence stating how many people are present] — *Reason: factual count*
6. [Pothwari sentence describing a road being constructed] — *Reason: factual description*
7. [Pothwari sentence asking where someone is going] — *Reason: plain question*
8. [Pothwari sentence stating the name of a place] — *Reason: factual information only*

4. Edge Cases

This section covers every difficult or ambiguous situation you may encounter. Read all of it carefully.

4.1 Sarcasm

If a sentence uses positive words but the clear intention is mockery, criticism, or the opposite of what the words literally say, label it NEGATIVE.

If you are not certain whether a sentence is sarcastic, label based on the literal words only. Do not assume sarcasm without clear evidence in the sentence itself.

Example:

- [Pothwari sentence meaning "Oh wonderful, you've broken it again" said mockingly] → NEGATIVE
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "Great job" said sincerely as a compliment] → POSITIVE

4.2 Mixed Sentiment

If a sentence contains both positive and negative feelings, choose the label that represents the stronger or dominant emotion overall.

If the positive and negative elements are genuinely equal and you cannot determine which is stronger, label NEUTRAL.

Example:

- [Pothwari sentence meaning "The food was good but the service was very bad"] → NEGATIVE, because the complaint about service is the dominant feeling being expressed
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "It was an okay experience, some things were fine and some were not"] → NEUTRAL, because neither side dominates

4.3 Code-Switched Sentences

It is natural for Pothwari speakers to mix Urdu or Punjabi words into their speech. This does not affect your labelling — assess the overall emotional tone of the sentence regardless of which language the individual words come from.

However, if a sentence is more than 60% Urdu words and contains barely any Pothwari vocabulary or grammar, do not label it. Select EXCLUDE instead and it will be removed from the dataset.

4.4 Questions

A plain question with no emotional tone is NEUTRAL.

A question that clearly expresses an emotion — frustration, excitement, sadness, disbelief — should be labelled according to that emotion.

Examples:

- [Pothwari sentence meaning "What time is it?"] → NEUTRAL
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "How many times do I have to explain this to you?!" expressing clear frustration] → NEGATIVE
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "Did you really get full marks?!" expressing excitement and pride] → POSITIVE

4.5 Prayers, Blessings, and Curses

These are very common in Pothwari speech and must be handled consistently.

- Prayers for someone's health, wellbeing, success, or long life → POSITIVE
- Expressions of gratitude to God → POSITIVE
- Curses, ill-wishes, or prayers for harm toward someone → NEGATIVE

Examples:

- [Pothwari blessing meaning "May God keep you safe and healthy"] → POSITIVE
- [Pothwari curse meaning "May God ruin your house"] → NEGATIVE

4.6 Proverbs and Idioms

Label by the sentiment the speaker clearly intends, not by the literal meaning of the individual words.

If the intended meaning is unclear from the sentence alone and no context is available, label NEUTRAL.

4.7 Very Short Sentences

Sentences of fewer than 5 words that cannot be clearly understood without additional context should be labelled NEUTRAL unless the sentiment is completely obvious from the words alone.

Examples:

- [Pothwari word or phrase meaning "Excellent!"] → POSITIVE, obvious from the word itself
- [Pothwari phrase meaning "He went"] → NEUTRAL, no emotion determinable

4.8 Factual Statements About Emotional Topics

A sentence can describe a sad, happy, or difficult event without the writer expressing any personal emotion. Label based on the emotional tone of the sentence, not the topic it describes.

Examples:

- [Pothwari sentence meaning "My grandfather passed away last year" stated as a plain fact] → NEUTRAL, no emotional expression
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "I am devastated since my grandfather passed away"] → NEGATIVE, clear emotional expression of grief
- [Pothwari sentence meaning "There was an accident on the road today" stated as news] → NEUTRAL, factual report

4.9 Religious and Political Statements

Label based on emotional tone only, not on your personal agreement or disagreement with the content. Your personal beliefs must not influence your label. If a religious or political sentence is stated as a neutral fact, label it NEUTRAL. If it expresses clear positive or negative emotion, label accordingly.

4.10 What to Flag for Exclusion

Do not assign a Positive, Negative, or Neutral label to the following. Select EXCLUDE instead:

- Sentences shorter than 5 words where the sentiment is not immediately obvious
- Sentences that are predominantly Urdu with minimal Pothwari content (more than 60% Urdu)
- Sentences with no clear or interpretable meaning
- Exact duplicate sentences
- Spam, gibberish, random characters, or broken text
- Sentences in a language other than Pothwari or mixed Pothwari-Urdu

5. Annotation Protocols

5.1 Inter-Annotator Agreement Protocol

Inter-annotator agreement is measured using Cohen's Kappa, calculated between two designated overlap annotators: the project lead and one designated second annotator.

Overlap set: 400 sentences selected randomly from the full cleaned dataset before annotation begins. These 400 sentences are assigned to both the project lead and the designated second annotator. All remaining sentences are assigned to single annotators only.

Independence requirement: The two overlap annotators must complete their labels entirely independently. No discussion, no comparison, no sharing of labels until both have fully completed the overlap set.

Calculation: Cohen's Kappa is calculated using `sklearn.metrics.cohen_kappa_score` in Python after both annotators complete the overlap set.

Target: Kappa of 0.80 or above. If Kappa falls below 0.75, annotation guidelines are reviewed, problematic categories identified, guidelines updated, and the overlap set re-annotated from scratch.

Interpretation scale used in this project:

Kappa Value	Interpretation
Below 0.60	Poor — guidelines require major revision
0.60 – 0.74	Moderate — guidelines require clarification
0.75 – 0.84	Good — acceptable for publication
0.85 – 1.00	Excellent — strong methodological validity

Annotator Timestamp Verification

Label Studio automatically records a timestamp for each annotation. The project lead reviews these timestamps after each session. Any session where 50 or more annotations were completed in under 20 minutes is flagged for quality review, as this pace is insufficient for genuine 30-second-per-sentence consideration

5.2 Annotation Rules and Process

Follow these rules strictly throughout every annotation session:

1. Read the full sentence completely before deciding on a label
2. Do not spend more than 30 seconds on any single sentence
3. If you are still unsure after 30 seconds, label it NEUTRAL and move on
4. Do not discuss your labels with other annotators during an active session
5. Do not look at what other annotators have labelled before completing your own labels
6. Complete a maximum of 50 sentences per sitting
7. Take a minimum 10-minute break after every 50 sentences — consistency drops significantly without breaks
8. Do not go back and change previous labels unless you discover you fundamentally misunderstood a guideline, in which case inform the project lead before making any changes
9. If you notice a sentence that seems offensive, harmful, or deeply inappropriate, flag it for the project lead rather than labelling or excluding it yourself

6. Practice Set

Before beginning real annotation, complete the following 20 sentences independently. Write your answers on paper or a separate document without consulting anyone. After completing all 20, compare your answers with the answer key provided by the project lead. If you disagree with more than 4 answers, re-read the guidelines and repeat the practice set.

Do not proceed to real annotation until you have passed the practice set.

#	Sentence	Your Label
1	[Pothwari sentence]	
2	[Pothwari sentence]	
3	[Pothwari sentence]	
4	[Pothwari sentence]	
5	[Pothwari sentence]	
6	[Pothwari sentence]	
7	[Pothwari sentence]	
8	[Pothwari sentence]	
9	[Pothwari sentence]	
10	[Pothwari sentence]	
11	[Pothwari sentence]	
12	[Pothwari sentence]	
13	[Pothwari sentence]	
14	[Pothwari sentence]	
15	[Pothwari sentence]	
16	[Pothwari sentence]	
17	[Pothwari sentence]	
18	[Pothwari sentence]	
19	[Pothwari sentence]	
20	[Pothwari sentence]	

Answer Key (provided separately by project lead after annotator completes the practice set)

7. Summary Reference Card

Print this and keep it visible during annotation sessions.

Label	Use when the sentence expresses...
POSITIVE	Happiness, praise, love, gratitude, satisfaction, excitement, approval
NEGATIVE	Sadness, anger, frustration, disappointment, criticism, complaint, fear, regret
NEUTRAL	Facts, plain questions, observations with no emotional tone
EXCLUDE	Too short, predominantly Urdu, meaningless, duplicate, gibberish

Golden rule: Label the emotion in the sentence, not your reaction to the topic.

8. Technical Encoding Requirements

All files in the PothwariSentiment project containing Pothwari text must be saved in UTF-8 encoding. This applies to every CSV file, every text file, and every document containing Nastaliq script.

For annotators submitting contributed sentences:

Type your sentences in any Urdu keyboard app on your phone and send them to the project lead via WhatsApp. Do not attempt to type and format your own CSV files. The project lead handles all file formatting.

For the project lead when handling files:

In Microsoft Excel: Never open a CSV file by double clicking it. Always open Excel first, go to Data → From Text/CSV → select your file → in the import wizard select UTF-8 encoding explicitly before finishing import.

In Notepad or any text editor: When saving any file containing Pothwari text, go to File → Save As → change encoding dropdown from ANSI to UTF-8.

In Python: Always use this exact syntax when reading or writing any file:

Python:

Reading a file

with open('dataset.csv', 'r', encoding='utf-8') as f:

data = f.read()

Writing a file

with open('dataset.csv', 'w', encoding='utf-8', newline='') as f:

writer = csv.writer(f)

Never omit encoding='utf-8' when working with Pothwari text in Python under any circumstances.

Verification check:

After saving any CSV file, reopen it and confirm the Nastaliq characters display correctly. If you see question marks, boxes, or random symbols instead of Nastaliq text, the encoding is wrong and must be fixed before the file is used.

9. Guideline Version Control & Update Protocol

9.1 Version Numbering

Every update to this document produces a new version number recorded at the top of the document. Minor clarifications that do not change any label definition increment the decimal — v1.0 becomes v1.1. Any change that redefines a label, adds a new edge case rule, or removes an existing rule increments the whole number — v1.0 becomes v2.0.

9.2 Freeze Point

These guidelines are considered frozen after the annotator training session. From that point forward, label definitions cannot change. Only clarifications of existing definitions are permitted, and only as minor decimal increments.

The freeze date is recorded here once the training session is completed: **[DATE TO BE FILLED AFTER TRAINING SESSION]**

9.3 If a Minor Clarification Is Needed After Freeze

A minor clarification means adding an example or explaining an existing rule more clearly without changing what the rule actually says.

Process:

- Project lead updates document to next decimal version
- All annotators are notified via WhatsApp with the specific change highlighted
- Annotators confirm receipt in writing
- No re-labelling required
- Change is documented in the version log below

9.4 If a Major Change Is Required After Freeze

A major change means any alteration to what a label actually means or covers.

Process:

- Stop all annotation immediately
- Project lead reviews all previously labelled sentences in the affected category
- Affected sentences are re-labelled from scratch under the new definition
- Version number increments to next whole number
- All annotators are retrained on the specific change before resuming
- The reason for the change and number of sentences re-labelled is recorded in the version log

9.5 Version Log

Version	Date	Type	What Changed	Sentences Affected
1.0	19 June 2026	Initial	Document created	N/A

Every future update adds one row to this table. This log is included as an appendix in the final published paper.

Collection Period Documentation

All sentences were collected between [START DATE] and [END DATE]. This collection period is documented to allow future researchers to contextualize any topical or temporal bias in the data.

10. Data Backup Protocol

10.1 Label Studio Export Schedule

At the end of every annotation session without exception, the project lead exports the current state of all annotations from Label Studio as a CSV file and commits it to the private backup branch of the GitHub repository.

This takes less than two minutes and is non-negotiable. No session ends without a backup being committed.

Export procedure:

- Open Label Studio project
- Click Export
- Select CSV format
- Save file as: annotations_backup_[DATE].csv using today's date in YYYYMMDD format
- Example: annotations_backup_20260621.csv
- Commit this file to GitHub immediately

10.2 Backup Folder Structure on GitHub

The GitHub repository maintains a dedicated folder called /backups/ containing every annotation export. Old backup files are never deleted — they accumulate as a timestamped history of the entire annotation process.

Your repository structure should look like this:

PothwariSentiment/

```
├ README.md
├ annotation_guidelines.md
├ .editorconfig
├ .gitignore
├ backups/
|   ├── annotations_backup_20260621.csv
|   ├── annotations_backup_20260622.csv
|   └ ...
├ raw_collected_data/ ← gitignored, never uploaded
└ scripts/
```

10.3 Secondary Backup

In addition to GitHub, the project lead maintains one additional backup of the most recent annotation export on Google Drive or any cloud storage service. This secondary backup protects against the unlikely scenario of both local machine failure and GitHub access loss simultaneously.

10.4 Contributor Sentence Backups

All sentences received from contributors via WhatsApp are saved in a dedicated WhatsApp chat and additionally copied into a Google Doc immediately upon receipt. Never rely on WhatsApp alone as a storage system — messages can be lost if a phone is changed or an account is deleted.

11. Baseline Experiment Plan

Upon completion of the annotated dataset, a baseline machine learning experiment will be conducted to demonstrate the dataset's utility for the sentiment classification task.

Experimental Setup:

Dataset split:

- Training set: 80% of final dataset (approximately 1,600 sentences)
- Test set: 20% of final dataset (approximately 400 sentences)
- Split is stratified — meaning each split contains approximately equal proportions of Positive, Negative, and Neutral labels

Model: Logistic Regression classifier using TF-IDF (Term Frequency-Inverse Document Frequency) character n-gram features. Character n-grams are used rather than word n-grams because Pothwari morphology is complex and character-level features capture subword patterns more effectively for low-resource languages.

Library: scikit-learn (Python)

Evaluation Metrics Reported:

- Accuracy (overall)
- Precision per class
- Recall per class
- F1 score per class
- Macro-averaged F1 score

Purpose of Baseline:

This experiment does not claim state-of-the-art performance. Its sole purpose is to demonstrate that the dataset contains learnable sentiment signal and is suitable for training machine learning classifiers. Results establish a benchmark for future researchers to improve upon.

Reporting:

Results are reported in a confusion matrix and a classification report table in the paper. All code used for the baseline experiment is published in the project GitHub repository under an MIT license for full reproducibility.

12. Target Journal: Data in Brief (Elsevier)

Manuscript must follow Data in Brief article structure exactly:

1. Specifications Table — mandatory structured table covering subject area, data type, data collection method, data source location, data accessibility, related research article
2. Value of the Data — minimum 4 bullet points explaining why this data is useful, who benefits, and how it builds on existing work
3. Data Description — what the dataset contains, its structure, statistics
4. Experimental Design, Materials and Methods — how it was collected, annotated, and validated
5. Dataset Access — Hugging Face link, Zenodo DOI, GitHub link

Paper length target: 4-6 pages excluding references. Data in Brief papers are deliberately short.

Submission checklist before sending:

- Dataset live on Hugging Face
- DOI obtained from Zenodo
- Cohen's Kappa score calculated and confirmed above 0.75
- Baseline experiment complete (Section 10)
- All author information and ORCID included